

Eggstreme Tendencies



It is fair to state that recently two large chunks of Indian sport have been left with egg on their faces. A slight mystery follows though: isn't egg actually flung by other people? Those with yolks that look like face-packs don't usually smear it on themselves. That, however, is exactly what the blessed BCCI and all connected to the Delhi 2010 Commonwealth Games (CWG) have done. The CWG folk will seek cleaning operations next week. The BCCI on their part will soon discover the impact of its long list of errors.

It all began for the BCCI with the fantasy event called the T20 Champions League. Three Indian teams from the IPL bling-tamasha were pounded by humble first-class squads from the West Indies, Australia and South Africa. There was no flashing strobe light signalling the IPL's unquestioned future as the cricket's new money-and-honey pot. Everything sounded instead like the loud creaking of a floorboard.

The IPL's impact on India's young cricketers now worries the BCCI's more thoughtful administrators. The main problem though is that they aren't too many of that kind. The majority gobble up cash grants and elbow onto cameras. At the Champions League party, a very senior BCCI official was dancing near a slinkily-dressed woman decades his junior with his drool in full sight.

But in this season of egg-loading, nothing matched what the BCCI's senior selectors did when they picked the team for the ODI series against Australia. A few months ago an old fellow was dusted out again for a tri-nation event in Lanka and the ICC Champions Trophy. The return of Rahul Dravid was grumbled about often but its logic was solid. His profession-

alism and ODI expertise would lead the flashier, distracted younger tykes to work harder. That was what was believed. Obviously, the five wise men weren't *that* wise: they just needed someone who could bat in South Africa. After that, no matter what he did, they could bin him like an old boot and 'Youngistan' could run riot on Indian wickets versus the Aussies.

There was no explanation of the selectors' new round of logic or cluttered choices. The BCCI chose to dismiss bowling coach Venkatesh Prasad and fielding coach Robin Singh without a word to them either. Maybe they think that all this is "toughness" but saying nothing only smells of guilt.

India desperately wants to become the world No. 1 team soon. Except in two 'world' events this year, M.S. Dhoni's team has tanked like a Bollywood dud. Well, Australia are here guys, and the best thing you could do with those eggs in your baskets is to fling them in their direction. Not at yours.



SAURABH SINGH/www.indiatodayimages.com

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: C.B. Muthamma, 85, India's first woman diplomat. She joined the diplomatic corps in 1949 and was the ambassador to Hungary, Ghana and The Netherlands.

DIED: Journalist and social activist **Theruvath Raman**, 93, who founded *Pradeepam*, the first Malayalam eve-



ninger. He was jailed for publishing an editorial in *Kahalam* weekly during the freedom struggle.

DIED: Apna Dal president **Sone Lal Patel**, 60, in a road accident in Kanpur. Apna Dal had contested the previous Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections in alliance with the BJP.

APPOINTED: Former Delhi police commissioner **Nikhil Kumar** as the governor of Nagaland. He had headed the National Security Guard, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police and was special secretary (Home).

